



Inspection Report

City of Greenville
150 Cleveland Park Drive
Greenville, SC 29601

Customer ID: **3273**
Certificate: **56-C-0009**
Site: 001
City of Greenville

Type: FOCUSED INSPECTION
Date: 12-AUG-2026

2.131(b)(1)

Handling of animals.

One Amur leopard was not handled as carefully as possible. On July 23, 2026, an adult female leopard escaped from its enclosure. An investigation of the event determined the leopard escaped through the keeper service door on the leopard's outdoor habitat. While cleaning in this area, the keeper had this habitat service door open while the adult leopard and two cubs remained secured in their respective holding dens. Prior to completing husbandry duties in the outdoor habitat, the keeper intended to shift the female leopard to another stall inside the holding building but opened the wrong shift door. This resulted in the leopard having access to the outdoor habitat instead, providing the leopard with a means of egress due to the service door remaining open.

While the zoo was not open to the public at this time, the animal care staff effectively implemented their Animal Escape Protocol. The leopard was captured and returned to its primary enclosure for continued monitoring and observations before being reunited with her cubs.

The mishandling of animals causes undue stress and discomfort to the animals, especially if capturing is required. Furthermore, escaped dangerous animals pose an imminent threat to other people and animals when they are not safely contained. All animal handling shall be done as expeditiously and carefully as possible in a manner that does not cause trauma, behavioral stress, physical harm, or unnecessary discomfort.

The facility corrected prior to this inspection on July 23, 2026.

This inspection and exit interview were conducted with the facility representatives.

Prepared By: CARLA THOMAS
USDA, APHIS, Animal Care
Title: VETERINARY MEDICAL
OFFICER

Date:
14-AUG-2026

Received by Title: Facility Representative

Date:
14-AUG-2026



Species Inspected

Cust No	Cert No	Site	Site Name	Inspection
3273	56-C-0009	001	City of Greenville	12-AUG-2026

Count	Scientific Name	Common Name
000004	<i>Panthera pardus</i>	LEOPARD
000004	Total	